



Finger-paint art

Babies are fascinated by their ability to make marks, and your baby will love to explore how to create art using his hands. Playing with paint will also help him gain confidence in expressing himself with mark-making materials.

To make your own nontoxic, edible paint

- ❖ Mix together 4 tablespoons each of cornstarch and boiling water. The mixture will thicken quickly to a paste. Gradually whisk in enough boiling water to achieve a consistency similar to heavy cream. Divide between shallow bowls and add a few drops of natural liquid food coloring to each to make a bright color. Allow to cool.
- ❖ Put a large wipe-clean mat on the floor or on a table that you can sit at with your baby on your knee and tape a large sheet of paper to the mat.
- ❖ Put an old undershirt on your baby, or take his top off, put the bowls down together or one at a time, and let him make splashy art with his hands.

Develop your baby's creativity

- ❖ Show him how to make different marks on the paper. Or help him make thumb, finger, and handprints in different colors, then use a felt-tip pen to turn the prints into fish swimming in the water, birds, a garden of flowers, or insects such as ladybugs or crickets hopping across the page.
- ❖ Try dipping a wide strip of fabric into the paint and show your baby how to drag and swish it around the paper to make trailing marks.
- ❖ Make a mirror image of his marks by folding the piece of paper in half, then reveal it to him with a "Taa daa!" as you open up the two halves.

